

After 20 weeks the loss is referred to as a stillbirth. The signs of a miscarriage are vaginal bleeding and period-like cramps.

Unfortunately, there is nothing that you can do to prevent a miscarriage. In around 60 percent of cases, it is caused by a one-time genetic problem. Bleeding does not always mean that the pregnancy is being miscarried. Since not all miscarriages follow the same pattern, there are various terms to describe what happens:

- **A threatened miscarriage** occurs when the pregnant woman experiences bleeding and possibly pain, but the baby survives.
- **An inevitable miscarriage** occurs when there is bleeding and pain due to the pregnant woman's uterus contracting. The cervix opens, and the fetus is expelled.
- **A missed miscarriage** is when the fetus dies but is not expelled. Surgery may be needed to remove it.